

COHORT #2 · FALL 2026

Join the second cohort.

A hands-on research community for students headed into finance. Here's exactly how the program works.

Fully remote

8 weeks

~8 hrs / week

~40 researchers

EDIT — CONFIRM DATES + HOURS

The goal is to become AI-literate and finance-fluent.

Independent · student-founded · not affiliated with any university, employer, or fund.

● THE MISSION

We figure out how AI is really used across finance.

Applied Intelligence Collective is an independent, student-founded research community studying how AI is actually being used across finance: what genuinely works, what's overhyped, and the real workflows behind it. You research a question you care about, publish real work, and build fluency that carries into your career.

Honest about what we are.

Independent and new. We're not affiliated with any university, employer, or fund, and the program is unpaid. What you get is real research experience, a portfolio, and a network.

● HOW WE LOOK AT EVERYTHING

Every question runs through three lenses.

They keep the work grounded and comparable across the whole cohort.

1

Efficient uses

Where AI genuinely creates an edge.

2

The ROI gap

Where cost and hype outrun the real payoff.

3

Real workflows

How the work actually gets done, day to day.

● YOUR QUESTION, YOUR CALL

Four areas. You scope your own question.

There's no fixed topic menu. You pick a two-month question inside one of four finance areas, and your team lead helps you shape it in week 1.

1

Investment Banking

2

Private Equity & Venture Capital

3

Wealth Management & Financial Planning

4

Corporate Finance

● THE STRUCTURE

Individual research. Collective growth.

Three layers of collaboration, each with its own purpose.

1

You research on your own

Your topic, your questions, your output. The research itself is yours to run with.

2

You share with your team

Present and compare notes with your group every week. That's where the learning compounds.

3

We shape the program together

The whole cohort keeps refining how we work, all program long.

● EVERY SINGLE WEEK

A simple weekly rhythm.

Small enough to keep up alongside school, real enough to build a portfolio.

1

300-word brief

A tight, sourced summary of what you found.

2

LinkedIn + infographic

An excerpt plus a visual of your research, published under your name.

3

Research deck

A few slides you present at the weekly Zoom.

Plus one thing that sets us apart.

At least one new practitioner outreach per week. Real conversations are what make the work citable instead of recycled hype.

● YOUR TWO MONTHS

Eight weeks, start to showcase.

EDIT — SET FALL DATES

WEEK 1

Plan & Scope

01

Set your topic and goals, meet your team, learn what makes research good.

WEEKS 2-6

Research & Publish

02

The weekly rhythm: research, ship, present, repeat.

WEEKS 7-8

Synthesize & Present

03

Final paper and deck, delivered at the Research Showcase.

A mid-point checkpoint keeps momentum.

Around week 4 the whole cohort shares preliminary findings. It's the single best way to keep a remote group from fizzling in the back half.

● WHERE THE EVIDENCE COMES FROM

Four ways to find real evidence.

1

Conversations & calls

Ask people how they actually use AI. 20 minutes is plenty, and warm intros go far.

2

Filings & disclosures

10-Ks, earnings calls, and investor materials increasingly spell out real AI use.

3

LinkedIn, Reddit & more

Done well, these surface practitioner workflows you won't find anywhere official.

4

Whatever else works

No fixed list. If you find a good source we didn't mention, use it.

Combine a few of these.

The strongest research triangulates. Don't lean on just one source.

● YOU'RE ON A TEAM

~40 researchers, 10 small teams.

Cohort #2 scales up so we can take on more, together. You're placed on a small team with a lead, a few researchers, and a reviewer who keeps the work sharp.

[EDIT — CONFIRM SIZE](#)

1

~40 researchers

Roughly double the founding cohort, drawn from BYU and beyond.

2

10 teams of ~4

A team lead, two to three researchers, and a reviewer on each.

3

A shared standard

Every team works to the same house framing and quality bar.

● AN OPPORTUNITY, NOT A REQUIREMENT

Some teams will do real client work.

AIC is beginning to offer research to real companies: a team of researchers on a company's own question about how AI is used in their industry. Strong researchers can be staffed on these paid engagements, alongside their own research. It's optional, and it's real experience with a real deliverable and a real deadline.

1

Real stakes

A company on the other side, an actual decision riding on your work.

2

A stronger resume line

"Delivered an AI-in-industry report for a real client" beats coursework.

3

Guided and reviewed

Every client deliverable goes through review before it ships. You're supported.

● NOT JUST READING ABOUT AI

You'll actually build with AI.

Half research, half hands-on. You use the tools while you study how the industry uses them.

1

Hands-on tools

Work with tools like Claude Code, Obsidian, and building your own agents.

2

AI certificates

Structured, encouraged tracks so you leave with credentials, not just exposure.

3

Learn by doing

Backed by research showing hands-on, AI-assisted learning sticks far better.

EDIT — LOCK EXACT TOOLS + CERT TRACKS

● BY THE SHOWCASE

What you'll walk away with.

1

A published portfolio

Briefs and posts with your name on them.

2

A capstone paper + deck

Your final research, presented at the Research Showcase.

3

Real AI-in-finance fluency

A grounded view of how the industry actually uses AI.

4

Possible client experience

Real deliverables for real companies, if you're staffed on a team.

5

A growing network

Your cohort, your leads, and the professionals you reach out to.

6

Hands-on AI skill

Tools and certificates you can point to, not just talk about.

● THE COMMITMENT

Real work, built around your life.

1

~8 hrs / week

Enough to build something real, sized to fit around a full course load.

2

Fully remote

Everything runs on Zoom and a shared workspace, plus optional in-person events.

3

Runs during the semester

Cohort #2 runs while school is in session, so the rhythm is steady, not crushing.

4

We handle the formatting

AI design agents turn your research into branded posts and decks. You focus on the research.

EDIT — CONFIRM WEEKLY HOURS

● GETTING IN

How to apply.

A short application, then a quick conversation. We're looking for curiosity and follow-through, not a finance resume.

1 · Apply

Fill out a short application about you and what you're curious about.

2 · Chat

A quick call so we can meet you and answer your questions.

3 · Start

Get placed on a team, scope your question, and begin week 1.

EDIT — APPLICATION LINK + OPEN/CLOSE DATES

Come build this with us.

The first cohort proved the model. Cohort #2 is where it grows. If you want to learn AI first, before the rest of finance does, this is the room.

REACH OUT ANY TIME

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